

DHS had sought to slash ICE body cams

Raft of violent incidents adds urgency to calls for more documentation

BY MARIA SACCHETTI

The Trump administration proposed massive cuts to Immigration and Customs Enforcement's body camera program for this fiscal year as officers surged into U.S. cities to arrest immigrants, calling into question the agency's commitment to deploying cameras.

In its initial budget proposal, the Department of Homeland Security said it planned to slash the body camera program's 22-person staff to three employees and reduce spending on the initiative from about \$20.5 million to \$5.5 million. Officials instead proposed "sustaining" the cameras ICE had last year to devote more resources to "frontline operations."

A string of violent incidents involving federal immigration officers — including the fatal shooting of Minneapolis resident Renée Good in her SUV this month — has added fresh urgency to calls from congressional Democrats and some Republicans for more body-worn cameras. In several use-of-force incidents, witnesses and Homeland Security officials have given wildly differing accounts of the confrontations. Yet the government has voluntarily released little officer-worn footage.

To address these concerns, House appropriators this past week said they would allocate about \$20 million for cameras for DHS, which oversees ICE and its sibling agency, Customs and Border Protection, and require the agency to report back on its progress in 30 days. But the House plan stops short of requiring officers to wear cameras, and some congressional aides and analysts said this past week that the extra money is meaningless if

SEE CAMERAS ON A6

Sprawling winter storm slams much of the U.S.



WILL NEWTON/GETTY IMAGES

A person exits their car after it got stuck in a blanket of snow in Little Rock on Saturday. A huge winter storm is bringing frigid temperatures, ice and snow to about 200 million Americans this weekend. The storm was poised to produce a thick, cement-like combination of snow and ice in the Washington region.

Long power outages might follow storm

BY BRADY DENNIS AND RUBY MELLE

The massive winter storm bearing down this weekend on a large swath of the nation, from the Southwest to the Mid-Atlantic, promises to cripple travel, cancel schools and civic gatherings, and impose frigid temperatures on tens of millions of Americans.

But another worry is looming for those in the path of the storm: Power outages and the very human dangers that come with them. More than 100,000 people were already

without power as of midday Saturday, the majority of them in Texas, where the power grid has struggled with freezing temperatures in recent years.

Other winter tempests in recent years have laid bare the frailties that exist: Freezing spells that have crippled gas production. Surges in demand that tax the grid. The buildup of snow and ice that overwhelms transmission lines and stymies crews trying to help restore power. Extended outages that can lead people to make dangerous choices, such as driving on slick roads

or using unsafe heat sources inside their homes.

Even as elected officials and energy companies insist they are better prepared than ever for such challenges, the coming storm might present yet another stiff test.

"I think this has the potential to rank up as one of the more consequential storms we've seen over the last five or six years," said Jim Robb, president of the North American Electric Reliability Corporation (NERC).

The blast of winter weather, which began delivering snow

and ice on Friday across the Rockies and Plains, is likely to cause a wave of impacts as it barrels through the Midwest, Southeast and up the East Coast through the weekend.

By Thursday, forecasters already were warning that accumulation of ice — a reality predicted throughout much of the South — could weigh down trees and overburden power lines, leaving residents across numerous states to endure the

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Shoveling snow: Tips from Post staff in the Midwest. **A11**

Minn. shooting sparks protests

DHS: MAN KILLED SATURDAY HAD GUN

Trump 'must end this operation,' Walz says

BY LAUREN KAORI GURLEY AND JUSTIN JOUVENAL

MINNEAPOLIS — A U.S. Border Patrol officer fatally shot a man in Minneapolis on Saturday morning, federal officials said. The incident sparked protests and violent clashes between demonstrators and authorities.

Minneapolis Police Chief Brian O'Hara described the victim as a 37-year-old White male, who was a resident of the city and believed to be an American citizen. The man was not identified by name, but O'Hara said he appeared to lawfully own a gun.

Agents were conducting a "targeted operation" when a man with a 9mm handgun approached them on the south side of the city, Department of Homeland Security Assistant Secretary Tricia McLaughlin said in a statement.

In a post on X, DHS said the man resisted attempts to disarm him.

City officials and Gov. Tim Walz (D) called on the Trump administration to pull back on its immigration enforcement surge in the state.

"Minnesota has had it," Walz wrote on X. "... The President must end this operation."

The report follows two shootings involving immigration agents in the city. On Jan. 7, an Immigration and Customs Enforcement officer shot Renée Good in her car, an incident that sparked widespread protests in Minneapolis. ICE agents also shot a man in the leg as he attempted to evade arrest on Jan. 14, federal officials said.

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Baker's immigration tale sends pie sales surging

Former civil engineer from Venezuela inspires with his story of remaking his life again and again

BY MARÍA LUISA PAÚL

Máximo Mendoza, 78, walks into a Miami supermarket every week and fills a cart until it can hold no more — flour, sugar, eggs and butter stacked high, the wheels groaning as he pushes it toward the register.

A few days later, those ingredients will reappear as pies: chocolate and guava. Full- and individual-size. Rolled, filled and baked by hand in the kitchen of Mendoza's Coral Gables, Florida, home, where pie pans crowd every surface.

What began as a small operation at farmers markets has grown into a full-fledged business, driven in part by Mendoza's decision to infuse his company branding with his immigration experience — sharing with customers how he had lost everything in Venezuela and started over in the United States.

Shortly after the business rebranded as Max & Crust in late November, Mendoza — known to customers as Grandpa Max — saw demand for his pies surge. Last month, he said, he received

more orders than ever and made more than 240 pies — starting before dawn, finishing long after midnight and filling his home with the smell of butter and sugar.

"It's practically industrial quantities," Mendoza said.

The pie business is a far cry from what Mendoza, a civil engineer by training with a long career in Venezuela, imagined he'd be doing in his 70s. For most of his life, he did not cook at all. In fact, he said with a laugh, "I used to burn water."

What brought him to the United States was not a lifelong dream of pastry-making but something quieter and more familiar to many immigrants: a life upended more than once by forces beyond his control, and the determination to keep starting over every time.

"You can't keep thinking about what you had before," said Mendoza, who immigrated in 2018, during the height of Venezuela's economic collapse. "If you have to start again, you start again. If you stay stuck in what you lost,

SEE PIES ON A16



ANNA VALENTINA COLANGELO

Máximo Mendoza, 78, owner of Max & Crust and known to customers as Grandpa Max, displays a pie in Coral Gables, Florida.

Scientists aim to train bodies to make their own Ozempic

BY DANIEL GILBERT

When Harith Rajagopalan considers the millions of patients who have taken a GLP-1 drug to treat diabetes or obesity, he sees a revolution that is failing to realize its promise. "We are literally lighting tens of billions of dollars on fire," he said.

Rajagopalan is referring to studies showing that most patients stop taking GLP-1 medications within a year or two, preventing them from reaping the long-term benefits like reducing

cardiovascular risk. A cardiologist by training, Rajagopalan believes there's a better way to harness the benefits of GLP-1 drugs: a gene therapy that, with a single infusion, can program the body to make more of the GLP-1 hormone naturally for years.

Rajagopalan is the co-founder of a small biotech firm making a long-shot bid to disrupt the booming weight-loss industry. His publicly traded company, Fractyl Health, says it is on track to begin a human clinical trial

SEE GLP-1 ON A14

Md. pipeline collapse causes sewage to spill into Potomac

BY DANA HEDGPETH AND CLARENCE WILLIAMS

Millions of gallons of untreated sewage have spilled into the Potomac River after part of a major pipeline collapsed near the Capital Beltway in Maryland.

For the past several days, D.C. Water crews have been working to install bypass pumps to contain the sewer overflow along the Clara Barton Parkway in Montgomery

County after the break was reported late Monday night.

A section of the 54-mile sewer line, known as the Potomac Interceptor, collapsed, resulting in a "significant overflow," according to officials with D.C. Water. The interceptor line is roughly 60 years old and carries up to 60 million gallons of wastewater daily from Loudoun and Fairfax counties, areas near Washington

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